

1 ENGROSSED SENATE
2 BILL NO. 1480

By: Seifried of the Senate

3 and

4 Caldwell (Trey) of the
5 House

6
7 An Act relating to career and technology education;
8 directing the Oklahoma Department of Career and
9 Technology Education to establish certain pilot
10 program beginning in certain school year; directing
11 the Department to designate two technology center
12 school districts to coordinate with public school
13 districts; directing certain technology center school
14 districts to designate employees to serve as
15 apprenticeship coordinators; providing duties of
16 coordinators; allowing certain students to
17 participate in apprenticeship opportunities and be
18 paid for work; directing certain participants to
19 indemnify and hold harmless certain participating
20 employers; providing exceptions; requiring execution
21 of certain agreement on a form prescribed by the
22 Department; requiring electronic submission of
23 certain report by certain date; providing for
24 contents of report; providing for codification;
providing an effective date; and declaring an
emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 14-127A of Title 70, unless
there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. Beginning with the 2026-2027 school year, the Oklahoma
Department of Career and Technology Education shall establish a two-

1 year apprenticeship pilot program to encourage participation in
2 youth apprenticeship programs.

3 B. The Department shall designate two technology center school
4 districts to coordinate with public school districts in this state
5 to make apprenticeship opportunities available to students.

6 C. A technology center school district designated to
7 participate in the pilot program created pursuant to this section
8 shall designate a district employee to serve as an apprenticeship
9 coordinator. The duties of an apprenticeship coordinator shall
10 include, but not be limited to:

11 1. Building relationships with employers in the area served by
12 the technology center school district to maximize availability of
13 apprenticeship opportunities;

14 2. Facilitating high school student participation in
15 apprenticeship opportunities; and

16 3. Coordinating with public school districts participating in
17 the pilot program.

18 D. Students who are age sixteen (16) and older and enrolled in
19 a public school district participating in the pilot program may
20 participate in an apprenticeship opportunity and may be paid for
21 work conducted as part of an apprenticeship opportunity.

22 E. 1. Public school districts and students that participate in
23 an apprenticeship opportunity pursuant to this section shall agree
24 to indemnify and hold harmless employers offering the apprenticeship

1 opportunity from claims arising from student participation except in
2 cases of gross negligence, willful misconduct, or a clear violation
3 of law.

4 2. Public school districts and students who are age eighteen
5 (18) and older or the parents or legal guardians of students who are
6 under the age of eighteen (18) shall execute an apprenticeship
7 participation agreement that indemnifies participating employers
8 from claims arising from student participation in an approved
9 apprenticeship opportunity. The Oklahoma Department of Career and
10 Technology Education shall prescribe the apprenticeship
11 participation agreement form required by this subsection.

12 F. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education
13 shall electronically submit a report to the Governor, the President
14 Pro Tempore of the Senate, and the Speaker of the House of
15 Representatives by December 1, 2028, that includes an evaluation of
16 the pilot program by participating public school districts and
17 technology center school districts, data on whether the pilot
18 program had an impact on increasing student participation in
19 apprenticeship opportunities, and recommendations for continuation
20 of the program.

21 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

22 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
23 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby
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1 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
2 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

3 Passed the Senate the 11th day of March, 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the Senate

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7 Passed the House of Representatives the ____ day of _____,
8 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

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